CYBERCAB FLEET OWNERS · VERSION 2.1

The Cybercab Fleet Implementation Guide

The 90-Day Fleet Plan : from first car to running fleet , a step-by-step guide by the expert team

Version 2.1 · Oct 31, 2026

Written by the expert team of the Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners community

cybercabfleetowners.com

Independent community, not affiliated with Tesla, Inc.

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> **Before you read**
> Not financial advice . Tesla has not published owner terms ; all plans are subject to Tesla's and local regulators' rules . This guide contains no earnings , return or fee figures .

THE METHOD

The 90-Day Fleet Plan

Most future fleet owners will be ready too late . The 90-Day Fleet Plan fixes that .

The problem
When a Robotaxi city launches , owner terms come out and the first cars join the network . Owners who start preparing on that day are too late : depots , insurance , funding and permits all take time .

Six steps , ninety days

1	2	3	4	5	6
City choice Ch . 1, 2, 12	**Depot** Ch . 3, 4, 5, 11	**Cost per km** Ch . 6	**Funding** Ch . 7	**Rules** Ch . 8	**90-day readiness** Ch . 9, 10

→ → → → → Ready to move on launch day

Step	Question it answers	Done when
1 City choice	Where can my cars run ?	1 to 3 cities shortlisted with legal status known
2 Depot	Where do the cars charge , get cleaned and park ?	At least one site with confirmed grid capacity
3 Cost per km	What does every kilometre cost me ?	Careful , middle and hopeful cases filled in
4 Funding	How do I pay for the first cars ?	Lender pack sent to at least one lender
5 Rules	Who decides what in my city ?	Each permit layer and authority listed
6 90-day readiness	Am I ready on launch day ?	All done-tests passed , phasing written down

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What's new in this version

Version 2.1 · Oct 31, 2026

- Chapter 1 : the timeline so far , customer cars joining around Q2 2027 and Cybercab sales by the end of 2026 , and the Texas fleet status of 31 Oct 2026 , 1,204 Robotaxis including 573 Cybercabs .
- Chapter 5 : depot , zoning and storage set your starting fleet size .
- Chapter 3 : insurance options to explore .
- Chapter 10 : new FAQ , how to qualify as a fleet operator and when private owners can add cars .

Version 2.0

- Country-specific examples generalised : chapter 8 now compares the US with Europe , and the city , grid and crowdfunding examples now apply across Europe .
- Chapter 6 : the depreciation section now includes the funding plan solution presented by Michiel van Duijn in Robotaxi Countdown episode 39 .
- Chapter 6 : new table , ten cost drivers per mile and per kilometre , from AJ (@alojoh) , Tesla Ride Hailing Cost Drivers , 8 May 2025 .
- Chapter 6 : two new deep dives from an expert business plan on operating and funding a Cybercab fleet : cleaning and charging as the biggest running costs after depreciation , and why depreciation depends on how the car is funded .
- Chapter 7 : new section , Growing a fleet from one car , on reinvesting cash flow into more cars and the real-world limits that slow it down , in our new chapter structure .
- Chapter 7 : new section , Three ways to take part : own and run , own with Tesla operating , or a pooled fleet , in our new chapter structure .
- Chapter 2 : new section , How a city tips , on dense corridors , airport access and how many robotaxis it may take to change a city , in our new chapter structure .
- Introduction rewritten in our new chapter structure : a human hook , the stakes , sourced proof points on safety , scale and adoption , one metric to watch and one community link . Chapter 8 : why rules are the real bottleneck , the levels of autonomy and the Arizona model . Chapter 4 : Tesla versus Waymo . Chapter 12 : China closing the gap . Sources : Social Capital .
- Chapter 6 and chapter 11 : new sections on deadhead , the empty kilometres an owner pays for , and how depot and charging placement reduce them .
- New introduction , Why Fleets : Owning the Mile : the expert team's view of how self-driving turns the car into a productive asset , with practical takeaways for owners .
- New chapter 12 , Where Owners Fit : the hybrid platform model , a layered rollout of the first cars , and niche services , under Step 1 City choice .
- Chapter 12 : new section on the airline model , fleets operating their own cars on Tesla's network with customised cabins over time .
- Chapter 6 : new section on the utilisation trade-off between busy cars and short wait times .
- New chapter 11 , The Four Pillars : staging , charging , cleaning and maintenance at fleet scale , under Step 2 Depot .
- New in Step 6 : what early owner pilots are likely to test , and what to track .

- New sources note , crediting @nymbusjp , @cernbasher , @farzyness , @m0xt_ and @chamath (Social Capital) .

Version 1.1

- New umbrella : The 90-Day Fleet Plan , our six-step method .
- Contents now grouped under the six steps : city choice , depot , cost per km , funding , rules and 90-day readiness .
- New one-page method overview .

Version 1.0

- First edition : all 10 chapters, from picking a city to a 90-day readiness plan .
- Renamed from the Fleet Owner Book to the Cybercab Fleet Implementation Guide .
- Figures dated 28 and 30 Oct 2026 : autonomous miles and Texas Cybercab registrations .

We release a new version whenever new facts come in , for example owner terms , city launches or regulation . Members of the community get every update first .

INTRODUCTION

Why Fleets : Owning the Mile

Introduction · the bigger picture

Think about your last commute . Hands on the wheel, eyes on the road, an hour you cannot use for anything else . According to Social Capital's deep dive, the average American worker spends about 225 hours a year commuting, nearly six working weeks . Self-driving gives those hours back . And it protects something more important : in 2025, more than 36,000 people died on US roads .

What this chapter covers
Why the car becomes productive capital · what changes around it · The proof so far · the one metric to watch · what it means for your plan

This introduction covers five things . Why a self-driving car becomes a working asset . What changes around it . The proof so far . The one metric to watch . And what all of this means for your fleet plan .

The proof so far

Three sourced data points

This is no longer a slide in a presentation . Three data points show how far it has come .

Safety
Waymo's peer-reviewed data : 170 million driverless miles · 92% fewer serious or fatal injury crashes than human drivers in the same conditions

Waymo's peer-reviewed safety data, across 170 million driverless miles, shows 92 percent fewer crashes with serious or fatal injuries than human drivers in the same conditions, as cited by Social Capital .

Scale
Commercial autonomous ride-hailing in 28 cities in five countries · Waymo : over 20 million paid driverless rides by end 2025 , about 500,000 a week

By the end of 2025, autonomous ride-hailing was commercially available in 28 cities across five countries . Waymo passed 20 million paid driverless rides and now delivers about half a million rides a week .

Adoption
Goldman Sachs : up to 65% of US car sales could be autonomous by 2040 · Delivery robots : millions of autonomous deliveries on campuses and sidewalks

Goldman Sachs expects that up to 65 percent of US car sales could be autonomous vehicles by 2040. And sidewalk delivery robots have already completed millions of deliveries on US campuses and city streets .

The car becomes productive capital

From idle asset to working asset

Today most cars are expensive assets that sit still most of the day and lose value . Once the driver is gone, a car can work for many hours a day and serve many riders . It starts to look less like a consumer product and more like a piece of infrastructure, financed and managed as such .

The value shifts
From owning a car to owning a network · Autonomy software · fleet · charging · dispatch · the customer

That moves value from owning a car to owning a network : the autonomy software, the fleet, the charging, the dispatch and the customer relationship . In the end, the prize is owning the mile .

Not a promise
A productive asset still depends on utilisation and terms · Not financial advice

A car that can work is not the same as a car that pays off . Whether it does depends on utilisation, costs and terms nobody has published yet . That is why this guide works with cost per kilometre and careful cases, not promises . Not financial advice .

What changes around the car

Labour, demand, land and insurance

The effects reach well beyond taxis .

Labour and demand
Driving jobs are the first to change · Cheaper mobility likely means more mobility

Taxi, rideshare and delivery driving change first, because the human operator leaves the cost of each trip . Cheaper trips probably mean more trips . People may own fewer cars while driving more kilometres in total . Children, older people, non-drivers, commuters and businesses all get easier access .

Geography bends
Parking loses value · land is released · Travel time becomes usable time

Parking loses value and urban land is freed up . When travel time becomes usable time, a longer commute hurts less . That widens the area around cities where people live and work . Rental cars, buses, short flights and some rail may come under pressure .

Insurance and liability
If autonomy is safer, the accident economy shrinks · Liability moves towards software, makers and fleet operators

If self-driving proves clearly safer than people, the whole accident economy shrinks : claims, repairs, towing, legal costs and replacement cars . Liability moves towards software, manufacturers and fleet operators . As an owner, you may be one of those operators .

The hidden layer
Ride time becomes attention · The cabin as office, screen, game room or shop

And ride time becomes attention . The cabin can become a screen, an office, a game room or a shop . Whoever controls the car controls a slice of that attention .

The one metric to watch
The cost of a kilometre · Your version : cost per kilometre, chapter 6

Social Capital names the price of a mile as the key metric to watch . For a fleet owner, the mirror image is your cost per kilometre . Chapter 6 shows how to build it, and chapter 11 how depot and charging placement keep it down .

Wider than robotaxis
Driverless trucks · delivery robots · Car insurance · injury law · traffic enforcement

Robotaxis are only one piece . Aurora plans more than 200 driverless trucks by the end of 2026. Delivery robots take on the last mile . And industries that exist because of human error, such as car insurance, personal injury law and traffic enforcement, face a structural rethink .

The central question

Who owns the machine, the software and the network ?

The pattern is the same as with AI elsewhere . Productivity rises, prices fall, output grows, less labour is needed, and owning capital matters more . So once the machine drives itself, the key question is : who owns the machine, the software and the network ?

What it means for your plan

Practical takeaways

For a future owner, Tesla will own the software and the network . Your part is the physical layer around the car . The 90-Day Fleet Plan is built around exactly that .

> **Charging and depot**
> Where your cars wait, charge and get cleaned · See chapter 5 , The Depot , and chapter 11 , The Four Pillars

Charging and a depot are the assets you can own . Chapters 5 and 11 show how to secure them and which one becomes the bottleneck first .

> **Dispatch and the customer**
> Tesla's network likely runs dispatch and the rider app · Your edge : uptime, location and niche

Tesla is likely to run dispatch and own the rider relationship . Your edge is uptime, good locations and the niches its own fleet may not cover . Chapter 12 , Where Owners Fit , looks at those niches .

> **Insurance and liability**
> Ask brokers who is liable for what · Track Tesla's owner terms on liability

Ask brokers early who carries which risk : you, Tesla, or the insurer . Add liability to your list of open questions until Tesla publishes owner terms .

> **Cabin services**
> Office, screen or entertainment options · Only if Tesla's terms allow it

Cabin services such as a mobile office or entertainment are interesting options . They depend completely on Tesla's terms, so keep them out of your base plan . See chapter 12 and our business-models material .

> **Join the community**
> Discuss this chapter on X : x.com/i/communities/1912893645050511710 · Pin your city : cybercabfleetowners.com

Discuss this chapter with other future owners in the Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners community on X, and pin your city on the fleet map at cybercabfleetowners dot com .

CHAPTER 1

The Window Is Opening

A year ago, owning a robotaxi was a slide in a presentation . Today you can hail a car with nobody in the driver's seat in six American cities . This chapter is about that window . What is open, what is still shut, and what you can do while it opens .

It starts with a city

Where driverless rides run today

Every fleet owner's story starts with a city . So let's start with where driverless rides already run .

Driverless today
Austin · Dallas · Houston · Miami · Orlando · Tampa

According to Tesla's robotaxi page, driverless rides are live in six cities . Austin, Dallas and Houston in Texas . Miami, Orlando and Tampa in Florida .

Announced, no dates
Las Vegas · Phoenix · San Antonio · Jacksonville

Four more are announced : Las Vegas, Phoenix, San Antonio and Jacksonville . No launch dates yet . Announced is not the same as live, so keep them in a separate column .

4,002,983

miles driven autonomously · tesla.com/robotaxi live counter, read 30 Oct 2026

Tesla's page counts just over four million miles driven autonomously . That counter is a live estimate . The last confirmed figure, in Tesla's first safety report, was three point one million .

Then the car itself . The first production Cybercab left Giga Texas in February 2026. Continuous production has run since April . Tesla's engineers say the line can currently build cars faster than Tesla deploys them .

573

Cybercabs registered in Texas · Texas DMV registry via trackers, 28 Oct 2026 · zero before 31 Aug

And deployment is moving . Texas registered its first Cybercabs at the end of August . By the twenty-eighth of October, the registry listed five hundred seventy-three, out of one thousand and eighty Tesla

robotaxis in the state .

Public Cybercab rides have run in Tesla's own Austin fleet since early September . Dallas Cybercab service is planned for November . Two seats, no wheel, no pedals .

The owner question

Can you buy one ?

Now the question this chapter really has to answer . Can you buy one ?

> **What exists today**
> No order page · no price list · No delivery date · an interest form

Here is what exists today . No order page . No price list . No delivery date . What there is, is an interest form on Tesla's robotaxi page, for people who want to operate their own robotaxi fleet .

> **What Tesla said on the Q3 call**
> Trying to reach customers by end of 2026 · Starting small · primarily a transport service

On its third-quarter call, Tesla said it is trying to get Cybercabs to customers by the end of 2026, starting small . It also said the Cybercab is primarily a transport service, with most units owned by Tesla .

> **The owner window**
> First customer cars on the network · Somewhere around Q2 2027

And Tesla suggested the first customer cars could join the robotaxi network somewhere around the second quarter of 2027. Subject to geofences and Tesla's fleet management . That is a target window, not a commitment .

A narrow window

Owner cars come later

So the window is real, but narrow at first . Most cars will be Tesla's own . Owner cars come later, and in smaller numbers, at least in the beginning .

> **Person or business ?**
> Not published yet · Plan as if it will be a business

People ask whether they can buy as a private person or only as a business . Tesla has not said . Some members think purely commercial fleet use is what Tesla intends . That is an opinion, not a fact . The safe plan is to prepare as a business anyway . A company makes insurance, funding and bookkeeping easier .

What is still unknown

Plan for it as a variable

Now the list that matters just as much . What is still unknown .

Unknown today
Price · owner terms · revenue split · City caps · insurance rules · cleaning standards

The price . The owner terms . How the revenue from rides is split . Whether cities get caps on owner cars . The insurance rules . Cleaning and quality standards . Technical rules . None of these have been published .

US oversight
NHTSA audit query into Cybercab self-certification · Opened 4 September 2026

There is also federal oversight in the US . On the fourth of September, NHTSA opened an audit query into Tesla's self-certification of the Cybercab . It is also rewriting safety standards for cars without manual controls . This mainly affects Tesla, but it could change timing and supply .

Europe

The window has barely opened

And in Europe the window has barely opened . Supervised driving is being approved country by country, but that still needs a driver, and driverless commercial taxis are not yet generally allowed . Chapter 8 covers the details .

What to do now

While the window opens

So what do you do with a window that is opening, but not open ?

Do now
Shortlist 1 to 3 cities · Fill in Tesla's interest form

You prepare everything you control . Shortlist one to three cities, and know their legal status . Fill in Tesla's interest form, so you are on the list .

Do now
Set up or choose an entity · Line up depot options · ask brokers

Set up or choose a company . Line up depot options with power for DC charging . Ask a few commercial fleet brokers what they would need to insure a driverless car .

> **Don't do yet**
> Commit money you can't take back · based on targets

And one thing not to do . Don't commit money you can't take back based on targets . A target window can move . Your preparation will still be worth it when it does .

The people who will move first when owner terms come out are the ones who did this homework now . That is what the rest of this book is for . City by city, cost line by cost line .

> **The timeline so far**
> Customer cars joining the Robotaxi fleet : around Q2 2027 · Cybercab sales : starting by the end of 2026

Tesla has said that customer cars can join the Robotaxi fleet around the second quarter of 2027, and that Cybercab sales start by the end of 2026, as noted from @fminderop on X (x.com/fminderop/status/2113575982217207887) . Dates can slip, so plan your ninety days backwards from a launch you can check, not from a promise .

> **Texas fleet status**
> 1,204 Tesla Robotaxis registered in Texas · 631 Model Y · 573 Cybercab , Cybercab nearly half

On 31 October 2026 Texas had 1,204 Tesla Robotaxis registered : 631 Model Y and 573 Cybercabs, with 124 Model Ys added in one batch, from @fminderop on X (x.com/fminderop/status/2116427880834150680) . The fleet is growing fast, and the Cybercab is quickly becoming a large share of it . Watch the registration counts : they are the best public signal of how fast a city fills up .

CHAPTER 2

Pick Your City

Ask a future fleet owner how many cars they want, and they will give you a number . Ask them where, and it gets quiet . Yet where is the bigger question . One of our members put it well : less how many, and more where I'd even be allowed to run one .

Our members plan in
Austin · Las Vegas · Athens, Georgia · Hamburg · Bordeaux · Bristol and more

Our community is spread wide . Members plan fleets in Austin, Las Vegas and Athens, Georgia, and across Europe, in cities such as Hamburg, Bordeaux and Bristol . Some say they will go with whichever city gets approval first .

Five tests for a city
1 Legal status · 2 Tesla status · 3 Demand · 4 Depot and power · 5 Weather

This chapter gives you five tests to run on any city . Legal status . Tesla's status there . Demand . Depot space and power . And weather . Let's take them in order .

Test 1

Legal status

Test one is the hardest filter . Is driverless service even legal where you want to run ?

United States
Federal safety rules for the car · State rules for driverless service

In the US, there are two layers . Federal rules cover the car itself . The states decide who may run driverless service on their roads . And every state is different .

Texas
TxDMV authorisation required · since 28 May 2026

Texas is the clearest case . Since the twenty-eighth of May 2026, companies running driverless vehicles commercially need an active authorisation from the Texas DMV . They must also show insurance and file an emergency plan .

California · Nevada · Arizona

California : DMV and CPUC permits needed · Nevada and Arizona : permits issued to Tesla

California needs permits from both the DMV and the CPUC for driverless rides . That is why Tesla's Bay Area rides still have a safety driver . Nevada and Arizona have issued permits to Tesla .

Europe

Experiments only, for now

In most of Europe the picture is very different . Driverless cars can usually only run today through a national experiment or pilot permit, often limited in time and tied to set roads . Supervised driving still needs a driver .

And for the rest of the EU, much depends on Brussels . A vote on extending FSD Supervised across the EU could come in December at the earliest . Driverless taxis need a different route again .

Test 2

Tesla's status

Test two : what is Tesla's status in your city ? There are three answers . Live, announced, or nothing yet .

Live
Austin · Dallas · Houston · Miami · Orlando · Tampa

Live means driverless rides today . That is Austin, Dallas, Houston, Miami, Orlando and Tampa .

Announced
Las Vegas · Phoenix · San Antonio · Jacksonville

Announced means Tesla has named the city, but has given no date . Las Vegas, Phoenix, San Antonio and Jacksonville .

Open question
Will owner cars be welcome in cities · where Tesla runs its own fleet ?

Being in a live city has a catch, though . Our community keeps asking whether owner cars will be welcome where Tesla already runs its own fleet, or whether cities will get caps on owner cars . Nobody knows yet . Treat it as a risk, not a given .

Test 3

Demand

Test three is demand . A robotaxi is only useful when it is busy .

Demand signals
Airports · nightlife · hospitals · Universities · events · dense housing

Look for places that create rides all day . Airports, nightlife, hospitals, universities, event venues and dense neighbourhoods . A city with many short trips keeps a car busier than a spread-out area with a few long ones .

Also look at who rides . A two-seat Cybercab suits singles and couples . If most trips in your area are families, that changes the picture .

Test 4

Depot and power

Test four is often where plans fail . Where do the cars sleep ?

Parking

Near the service area

A fleet needs parking near the service area, safe and easy to reach . In many cities the hard part is not the car . It is the space .

Power
DC charging needs a strong grid connection · Ask the grid operator before you sign

And power . Reports say the Cybercab charges on DC only . Fast chargers need a strong grid connection . In many regions, grid congestion can mean a long wait for a bigger connection . Ask the grid operator before you sign a lease .

Test 5

Weather

Test five is weather, and it cuts both ways .

Rain, snow and fog test any self-driving system . Tesla's first driverless cities are all in Texas and Florida . Bad weather may also bring more ride requests, when fewer people want to walk or cycle . Count both sides .

Putting it together

Score your shortlist

So how do you put the five tests together ?

Score each city
Legal · Tesla · Demand · Depot · Weather · Shortlist one to three

Score each city on all five . Legal status and Tesla's status are pass or fail . Demand, depot and weather are where cities differ . End with a shortlist of one to three cities .

And keep a second choice . If your first city caps owner cars, or the rules slip, you want somewhere else you have already checked . Members in regions where rules move slowly know this best . Their first step may be a pilot, or a city across the border .

How a city tips

When robotaxis meet ride-hailing

Picture a Friday night in downtown Austin . You open the app, and a driverless car is two minutes away . The human driver is twelve minutes away . Which one do you take ? That simple choice, repeated thousands of times, is how a city tips . It decides how fast your city fills up with robotaxis, and which corners of it are still open for you .

What this section covers
Why dense corridors and airports go first · How many cars it may take · what to watch · what it means for your city choice

This section covers why the dense corridors and the airport go first, how many cars it may take to change a city, the one metric to watch, and what that means for your shortlist .

Proof point 1 : hours on the road
A human driver typically works 6 to 10 hours a day · A Cybercab can operate 20 hours or more

Analyst @cernbasher compares the two models in Austin . A human driver usually drives six to ten hours a day . A Cybercab can operate twenty hours or more . So a few hundred driverless cars can serve a large share of a city's rides .

Proof point 2 : the dense corridors first
Downtown, short, high-frequency trips go first · Then fewer rides per driver , longer waits , more riders switch

In his analysis, robotaxis first take the densest, short, frequent trips downtown . Drivers then get fewer rides per hour, some leave the platform, wait times rise, and even more riders switch . The network effect that built ride-hailing runs in reverse .

Proof point 3 : the airport and the threshold
Austin-Bergstrom handled over 21 million passengers in 2025 · His estimate : a few hundred cars already change Austin's market

Airport trips are among the most valuable rides . Austin's airport handled more than 21 million passengers in 2025, and access to it speeds up the shift . His estimate : around 250 Cybercabs create visible disruption in Austin, and around 800 to 1,200 break the human-driver model . These are his estimates, not Tesla figures .

> **The metric to watch**
> Your cost per kilometre against the local market · See chapter 6

The one metric to watch is still cost per kilometre . In his framing, a labour model has costs that grow with every ride, while a capital model has mostly fixed costs, so each extra ride improves the picture . Utilisation decides which side of that line your car is on .

> **Wider than taxis**
> Ride-hailing platforms may partner or become aggregators · The same labour-to-capital shift may reach other robots

Ride-hailing platforms are not standing still . They may partner with autonomous fleets, become aggregators of demand, or move into logistics . That could mean more than one network for owner cars in the long run . He sees the same shift from labour to capital coming to other robots .

> **What it means for your city choice**
> Dense corridors and airports may fill with Tesla's own cars first · Ask : is airport access allowed ? Where is demand outside the core ?

For step 1 of the plan : expect Tesla's own fleet to take the dense corridors and, where allowed, the airport first . Check whether robotaxis have airport access in each city on your shortlist, and look for demand outside the core, as chapter 12 describes .

CHAPTER 12

Where Owners Fit

Platform, rollout and niche markets

Will Tesla keep every Cybercab, or sell them ? Analyst @cernbasher argues the answer is probably both . This chapter looks at what a mixed model would mean for where, when and how a future owner fits in .

A hybrid platform

Tesla's fleet and owners' fleets side by side

In his view, the strongest model is a hybrid . Tesla owns enough cars to seed markets, guarantee quality and control the early experience . It also sells cars to individuals, fleet operators and businesses .

> **What Tesla has said**
> Cybercab to replace the Model Y robotaxi fleet over time · Deliveries depend on allocation between sales and Tesla's own fleet

He points to Tesla's first-quarter 2026 update . It said the Cybercab should become the largest-volume vehicle in the robotaxi fleet over time, and that deliveries depend partly on allocation decisions between sale to customers and Tesla's own fleet . Tesla also said its autonomy work supports both its own fleet and customer-owned vehicles .

> **The platform logic**
> Owners bring capital and their own parking, charging and cleaning · Tesla stays the operating system

The argument is the same as other platforms : an online marketplace does not own every product, and a home-sharing platform does not own every home . Owners fund part of the expansion and bring their own infrastructure, while Tesla runs the network .

> **The airline model**
> Fleet owners buy the cars and run them on Tesla's network · Over time, cabins customised for specialised uses

Analyst @farzyness compares it to an airline model . Fleets buy the cars and operate them on Tesla's network, much as airlines fly aircraft they buy from a manufacturer . Over time, he expects the body above the base car to be customised for specialised uses . For your plan, that means your edge may

come from how you run and fit out your fleet, not from the car itself . This is his reading, not a Tesla announcement .

Where owner cars may fit

Beyond the dense city centre

He expects Tesla's own cars to focus on the densest, busiest places : city centres, airport corridors and business districts .

Owner territory
Suburbs · smaller cities · resorts · campuses · Hotels · business parks · retirement communities

That leaves a lot of ground for owners : suburbs, smaller cities, resorts, university campuses, business parks, hotels and retirement communities . For step 1 of the plan, add one question to every city on your shortlist : is there a niche or district Tesla's own fleet is unlikely to cover ?

Who gets the first cars ?

A layered rollout

Tesla has spoken about owners as fleet shepherds, overseeing autonomous cars rather than driving them . So who gets the first ones ? He compares three options : rideshare drivers first, Tesla owners first, or professional fleet operators first .

His likely answer : a hybrid
Phase 1 : professional fleets and top rideshare drivers · reliability first · Phase 2 : ordering windows for Tesla owners · Phase 3 : broad access with financing

His expectation is a layered rollout . First professional fleets and a small group of high-performing drivers, to keep early operations reliable . Then ordering windows for Tesla owners . Then broad access with financing, especially for displaced drivers . This is his analysis, not Tesla's plan .

What this means for your plan
Look professional early : entity, depot, insurance, operations partner · Track ordering windows and eligibility rules

If reliability comes first, owners who can show a professional setup may be better placed . That is exactly what steps 1 to 6 of the plan build : a company, a depot, insurance quotes and a clear answer to who runs operations . Track any ordering windows and eligibility rules as an open question .

Competition beyond Tesla and Waymo
China is closing the gap in 2026 · Plan for more than one network over time

Social Capital's deep dive also flags that Chinese players are closing the gap on Waymo in 2026. For an owner, that is a reminder : in the long run, more than one network may compete for riders and for cars in your city .

Niche services

More than a taxi

He also sees uses beyond rides for the general public .

> **Medical transport**
> Patients to clinics, therapy and imaging · medical goods between sites · The screen as a mobile check-in room

One is healthcare . Patients who cannot drive could be taken to appointments, and the screen could handle registration and questionnaires on the way . Hospitals also move supplies, samples and kits between sites every day . Medical work brings its own privacy and safety rules, so check those before you plan around it .

> **Screens and off-peak work**
> In-cabin screens as an advertising network · Deliveries in quiet hours

Another is the screen as an advertising network, for example during large events . And in quiet hours, cars could deliver food or packages . Whether owners can offer any of these depends on Tesla's terms . Treat them as options, not as part of your base plan .

> *“Tesla does not need to own every car to own the network.”*
> *Paraphrased from @cernbasher, X article, 9 Jul 2026*

His summary, in short : Tesla does not need to own every car to own the network . For a future owner, that is the opening .

CHAPTER 3

How the Owner Model Could Work

How does owning a car on Tesla's network actually work ? It is the second most asked question in our community . The honest answer is that nobody outside Tesla knows yet . So this chapter does not guess . It lays out the possible models, the open questions, and what to ask .

Two roles
Network operator : app, riders, dispatch · Asset owner : the car, and the costs of keeping it

Start with two roles . The network operator runs the app, finds the riders and sends cars to them . The asset owner owns the car, and carries the costs of keeping it on the road . In a robotaxi network, these do not have to be the same party .

What Tesla has said
Cybercab is primarily a transport service · Most units owned by Tesla

Here is what Tesla said on its third-quarter call . The Cybercab is primarily a transport service, and most units will be owned by Tesla . So Tesla plans to be both the network operator and the biggest asset owner .

And for owners
First customer cars could join the network · somewhere around Q2 2027

It also said the first customer cars could join the robotaxi network somewhere around the second quarter of 2027. Subject to geofences and Tesla's fleet management . That is a target window . The terms that come with it have not been published .

Three scenarios

Plan for all of them

So instead of one model, plan for three scenarios . None of them is confirmed .

Scenario A
Tesla runs its own fleet · Owner cars wait, or stay very limited

Scenario A . Tesla mainly runs its own fleet, and owner cars stay limited for a long time, or join only in a few places . In this case, your preparation still has value . But you may have to wait, or look at other routes .

> **Scenario B**
> Your car on Tesla's network · Tesla runs app, riders and dispatch

Scenario B . You own the car, and it runs on Tesla's network . Tesla handles the app, the riders and the dispatch . You, or someone you hire, handle charging, cleaning, insurance and repairs . This is closest to what Tesla has hinted at .

> **Scenario C**
> Your car, run by an operator partner · Partner handles the daily work

Scenario C . You own the car, but an operator partner runs the daily work for you . Charging, cleaning, maintenance, maybe insurance . The car may still run on Tesla's network . You stay the owner, with less work, and less control .

Cybercab as a Service

Two tiers

That is the model behind our own Cybercab as a Service offer, with two tiers . Full operations, where we handle charging, cleaning, insurance, maintenance and network operations, and you own the car . Or operations only, where you handle charging and cleaning, and we handle the rest . Terms are agreed per owner .

The open questions

What nobody knows yet

Now the open questions . These are what will decide whether any scenario works for you .

> **The split**
> How ride money is divided is not published · Treat it as a variable, never as a fact

First, the split . How the money from each ride is divided between Tesla and the owner has not been published . You will see numbers on social media . They are guesses . In your plan, the split is a blank cell, tested across a range .

> **Who pays for what**
> Charging · cleaning · insurance · repairs · Each job you hand off changes your share

Second, who pays for what . Charging, cleaning, insurance and repairs all cost money . Who carries each one will shape your result as much as the split itself . Each job you hand off is likely to change what you keep .

Caps and geofences

Set by Tesla's rules

Third, caps and geofences . Tesla's own words say owner cars would be subject to geofences and fleet management . So the network decides where your car may drive . Our members' most asked question is whether there will be a cap on owner cars per area .

> **Community questions**
> Caps on owner cars per city ? · Cities excluded where Tesla runs its own fleet ?

Two more questions come up again and again . Will some cities be closed to owner cars, because Tesla already runs its own fleet there ? And will big fleets with high cleaning standards get priority over small owners ? Nobody has answered either .

> **Quality rules**
> Cleaning and quality standards · Technical rules for owner cars

Fourth, quality rules . Expect Tesla to set cleaning, quality and technical standards for owner cars . What they are, and what happens if you miss them, is unknown .

Co-ownership

Sharing a fleet

Some members want to share a fleet with friends, family or partners . That is co-ownership .

Co-ownership usually means a company that owns the cars, with several shareholders . It can make a fleet reachable for people who could not fund it alone .

> **Before you share**
> Shareholder agreement · decision rules · exit terms · May count as a regulated offering : get legal advice

But it needs care . Write a shareholder agreement, clear decision rules, and exit terms for when someone wants out . And in some setups, asking others to put money into a fleet counts as a regulated offering . Get legal advice before you invite anyone in .

What to ask Tesla

When the terms come out

Finally, what to ask, when Tesla publishes owner terms .

> **Ask about money flows**

> How is ride money divided ? · Who pays charging, cleaning, insurance, repairs ?

Ask how ride money is divided, and who pays for charging, cleaning, insurance and repairs .

> **Ask about access**
> Which cities and areas are open to owner cars ? · Caps per city · how rides are assigned

Ask which cities and areas are open to owner cars . Whether there are caps per city . And how rides are assigned between Tesla's cars and owner cars .

> **Ask about rules**
> Cleaning and quality standards · What happens if a car falls short

Ask what the cleaning and quality standards are, and what happens if a car falls short .

> **Ask about the exit**
> Can you leave the network ? · Can you sell the car, and to whom ?

And ask about the exit . Can you leave the network, and can you sell the car, and to whom ? An asset you cannot sell is a very different asset .

Until those answers exist, the best owner plan is one that survives all three scenarios . Prepare your city, depot, insurance and funding . And sign up through Tesla's interest form, so you are in line when the terms appear .

> **Insurance options to explore**
> Ask brokers for autonomous or fleet cover · New insurers are starting to offer autonomous policies

Insurance is one of the biggest open questions . Community members point to insurers that are starting to offer policies for autonomous driving, and to fleet cover from specialised brokers . Ask at least two brokers for a quote or a letter that describes how they would cover a driverless car on a ride-hailing network, and who is liable when the car drives itself . Put that letter in your lender pack .

CHAPTER 4

Built for Uptime

A private car sits parked most of the day . A robotaxi should not . So when Tesla's engineers design a car for a fleet, they design for one thing above all : uptime . This chapter reads their choices the way a fleet owner should .

> **Our source**
> Munro Live : Tesla Cybercab Deep Dive · with Lars Moravy and team · 26 Oct 2026

Our source is a long interview Munro Live recorded with Tesla's Cybercab engineering team, published on the twenty-sixth of October . Quotes here are short and paraphrased where needed . Watch the original for the full context . The link is in the description .

> **Two bets on the same problem**
> Tesla : cameras and one end-to-end neural network · Waymo : lidar, radar, cameras and detailed maps

Tesla and Waymo make two very different bets on the same problem . Tesla uses cameras and a single neural network that learns to drive from fleet data . Waymo combines lidar, radar and cameras with detailed maps of each area it serves . Social Capital's deep dive compares both strategies . For an owner, Tesla's bet is the reason the Cybercab can be simpler and has fewer sensors to maintain .

The interview walks the Cybercab line at Giga Texas . What stands out is how the car is built . Not as one body that gets filled up, but as separate modules .

> **Unboxed build**
> Front, rear, side and centre modules · Each module self-tested before final assembly

Tesla calls it the unboxed build . The front, rear, sides and centre are built as separate modules, and each one is tested on its own before it goes into the car . For an owner, that is a reliability signal worth tracking in the first fleet months .

Lesson 1

Downtime is a cost line

The first lesson for owners : downtime is a cost line, and the engineers know it .

> *“We want to make the drive inverter serviceable without having to basically tear the car from the underside out.”*

> *Tesla engineering team · Munro Live interview with Tesla's Cybercab team, 26 Oct 2026*

Here is one example . The service teams asked early on for the drive inverter to be serviceable without tearing the car apart from underneath . The engineers say they built it that way .

> **Thermal system**
> From refrigerant to a coolant loop · Can be flushed, primed and sealed

Another example is the thermal system . The team moved from refrigerant to a glycol coolant loop, which can be flushed, primed and sealed . Fewer specialist repairs means simpler work for a service partner .

> **Your cost model**
> Days off the road per repair · Ask for real downtime data

For your cost model, this points to one variable : days off the road per repair . Ask for real downtime data per repair type once owner cars are on the network .

Lesson 2

Useful life drives depreciation

The second lesson is about how long the car lasts .

> *“The car is going to run half a million miles at least.”*
> *Tesla engineering team · Munro Live interview with Tesla's Cybercab team, 26 Oct 2026*

The engineers said it plainly . The car is going to run half a million miles at least . They talk about doubling the useful life of a normal car, because a robotaxi runs so much more every day .

> *“Replacing an entire pack before half a million miles is a killer on cost.”*
> *Tesla battery team · Munro Live interview with Tesla's Cybercab team, 26 Oct 2026*

The battery team added that replacing a whole pack before half a million miles would be a killer on cost . That is why they think about remanufacturing and pack serviceability . The pack is built so a single module can be replaced instead of the whole pack .

For an owner, useful life is the biggest driver of depreciation per kilometre . Treat half a million miles as Tesla's design goal, not a guarantee . Test a shorter and a longer life in your model .

> **Small knocks, less downtime**
> Pyro fuse replaced by interrupting contactors · A low-speed knock need not force a pack service

One more battery detail . Tesla replaced the pyro fuse with contactors that can open under load and keep working . The team said many pyro events come from low-speed crashes where the high-voltage system is fine . For an urban fleet with many small bumps, that could mean less downtime .

Lesson 3

Energy and charging

The third lesson is energy and charging .

Efficiency
Tesla's most efficient EV, by its own account · New thermal module and in-house drive unit

The engineers call the Cybercab the most efficient EV Tesla has built, thanks to its thermal module and drive unit . Still, use measured energy per kilometre from early fleets in your model, not brochure claims .

Charging speed
Faster charging, more uptime · Fewer charging posts needed

Charging speed matters for the depot as well . The battery team put it simply : the faster you charge, the more uptime you get, and the fewer charging posts you need . Ask for real charge-rate data before you size a depot .

Charging today
A normal charge port for existing infrastructure · Automated charging explored, maybe Optimus later

The car keeps a normal charge port, because it has to use the charging infrastructure that exists today . More automated charging is being explored, and the team mentioned Optimus helping later . Plan your depot for plug-in charging now . Treat automation as an upside .

Lesson 4

Built for the city

The fourth lesson : this car is built for city duty .

City gearing
Gear ratio changed from about 9 to 11 · A robotaxi does not need a high top speed

Tesla changed the gear ratio from around nine to eleven, because a robotaxi does not need a high top speed . Keep your business case on urban and suburban rides .

The doors help too . The engineers said the seat sits at the height of a standard wheelchair, and the low step makes getting in and out easier . Accessibility could widen your rider base, for example older riders .

> *“For the consumer it's just going to come down to the cost per mile.”*
> *Tesla engineering team · Munro Live interview with Tesla's Cybercab team, 26 Oct 2026*

And then the line that ties it all together . For the consumer, it is just going to come down to the cost per mile . For you as an owner, that means your cost per kilometre against the network's ride price . Our White Paper 2 video covers that framework .

> **Limits on scale**
> Parts · infrastructure · parking spots · Different city by city

The team also said every operator will run into limits . Parts, infrastructure, even parking spots . Local depot space and grid capacity can be real advantages for an owner . Secure them early .

> **Fast improvements**
> Hardware and software improved week over week · Expect versions : buy in phases

Finally, they said Tesla improves the product week over week, on software and on hardware . Expect hardware versions . Phase your purchases, and don't lock your whole fleet into the first batch .

Five questions to ask

Before you buy

So here are five questions to ask before you buy .

> **Ask Tesla**
> 1 Downtime per repair type · 2 Battery module policy · 3 Charge rate · 4 Expected useful life · 5 Version roadmap

One, the downtime per repair type . Two, the battery module replacement policy . Three, the real charge rate . Four, the expected useful life . And five, the version roadmap . Their answers will fill the most important cells in your model .

CHAPTER 5

The Depot

Parking, Charging, Cleaning

Where does it sleep ? That question comes up in almost every serious conversation about a robotaxi fleet . A robotaxi works all day, but it still has to charge, get cleaned and park somewhere between peaks . This chapter is about that place . The depot .

> *“If there is no storage question, I'd buy one or two.”*
> *Community member, Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners*

Our members feel this . One wrote that if there were no storage question, they would buy one or two . Another plans three to five cars at the start, depending on infrastructure for storing and charging . The depot often sets the size of the fleet, not the other way round .

Part 1

Charging

Let's start with charging, because it shapes everything else .

> **What we know**
> NACS port, DC charging only · No onboard AC charger (reported)

Hands-on reports from September say the Cybercab charges through a NACS port, on DC only, with no onboard AC charger . Treat that as reported until Tesla publishes the specs . If it holds, a normal home socket or an AC wallbox will not do .

> *“The faster you charge it, the more uptime you get, the fewer posts you need.”*
> *Tesla battery team · Munro Live interview, 26 Oct 2026*

Tesla's engineers designed the battery for uptime . In their words : the faster you charge it, the more uptime you get, and the fewer posts you need . So charge speed decides how many chargers a depot needs per car .

> **Charging today and later**
> A normal charge port for existing chargers · Automated charging : an upside, not a plan

They also kept a normal charge port, so the car can use the chargers that already exist . More automated charging is being explored for later . Plan your depot for plug-in DC charging now, and treat automation as a bonus if it comes .

How many posts per car ?
Charge speed · kilometres per day · When the cars can charge

How many posts you need depends on three things . The charge speed, the kilometres each car drives per day, and when the cars can charge . Off-peak hours at night help, but a busy fleet will also need to top up during the day .

Own, contract or public ?
Your own DC chargers · A charging contract · public fast chargers

Then decide who owns the chargers . Your own DC chargers on site . A contract with a charging company . Or public fast chargers . Each choice changes your energy price, your control and your risk .

Part 2

Power and the site

Chargers are only as good as the power behind them . So part two is power and the site .

Grid capacity
How many kW can the site supply at once ? · Lead time for a bigger connection ?

Ask how many kilowatts the site can supply at the same time, and how long it takes to get a bigger connection . In many regions, grid congestion can mean long waits . Talk to the grid operator early, before you sign anything .

Energy price
Day and night tariff · demand charges · On-site solar or battery storage

Look at the energy contract too . Day and night tariffs, charges for peak demand, and whether solar panels or battery storage on site could help .

The site

Inside or near the service area

Then the site itself . It should sit inside or near the likely service area, with fast access to main roads . Safe, lit and fenced .

Access for a car with no driver
Gates · barriers · ramps · Who handles a car that gets stuck ?

And think about access in a new way . Can a car with no driver get in and out on its own, through gates, barriers and ramps ? And who goes out when one gets stuck ?

Permits
Zoning for commercial parking and charging · Fire-safety rules for indoor EV charging

Finally, permits . You may need zoning or land-use approval for commercial parking and charging . And indoor EV charging often has its own fire-safety rules . Check both with your municipality .

Part 3

Cleaning and daily operations

Part three is the one riders notice most . Cleaning and daily operations .

Cleaning and quality

Riders judge the interior

Riders judge a robotaxi by its interior . Our members expect Tesla to set cleaning and quality standards for owner cars, so plan for them now . The depot needs a cleaning bay with water, drainage, a vacuum, supplies, and room to inspect the interior .

The daily cycle
Quick check and clean between peaks · Deep clean on a fixed schedule · exterior by weather

A good daily cycle has three layers . A quick check and clean between peaks . A deep clean on a fixed schedule . And an exterior wash, depending on the weather .

Incidents
Spills · lost items · damage · Response time drives downtime

Then incidents . Spills, lost items and damage will happen . Decide who handles them and how fast . Response time drives downtime .

Maintenance
Tyres · wipers · brakes · glass · Sensor cleaning · software updates

Maintenance covers tyres, wipers, brakes, glass, sensor cleaning and software updates . Tesla's engineers say the drive inverter can be serviced without tearing the car apart, and the battery is built from modules that can be replaced one by one . Both aim at less downtime .

Part 4

Who does the work ?

So who does all this work ?

> **Three models**
> Do it yourself · hand off part · Hand off everything

There are three models . Do it yourself . Hand off part of it . Or hand off all of it . Many members plan a fleet next to a job, so this choice matters .

> **Cybercab as a Service**
> Full operations : we run charging, cleaning, insurance, · maintenance and network operations; you own the car

Our own Cybercab as a Service offer has two tiers . Full operations : we handle charging, cleaning, insurance, maintenance and network operations, and you own the car .

> **Cybercab as a Service**
> Operations only : you charge and clean, · we handle insurance, maintenance and network operations

Operations only : you handle charging and cleaning, and we handle insurance, maintenance and network operations . Terms are agreed per owner .

Whatever model you pick, the depot is where it starts . Space, power and a cleaning routine are things you can secure today, long before the owner terms come out .

> **Depot , zoning and storage set your starting size**
> How many cars you can park, charge and clean decides how many you start with · Zoning can rule out a home depot

Community members keep reaching the same conclusion : the number of cars you start with is set less by money than by space . Where the cars wait, charge and get cleaned limits the fleet . Zoning is a common barrier for a depot at home, because many residential areas do not allow commercial vehicle storage or fast chargers . Check zoning, storage and grid capacity before you decide how many cars to order .

CHAPTER 11

The Four Pillars

Staging · charging · cleaning · maintenance

A robotaxi only works when four jobs around it work too . It needs a place to wait, a plug, a clean cabin and the occasional repair . This chapter looks at each pillar at fleet scale, based on an analysis by @nymbusjp, and asks what it means for a future owner .

Pillar 1 : staging

Where cars wait between rides

Staging is the most basic need, and the most underestimated . Idle cars need safe, predictable places to wait between rides, during charging and cleaning, and in quiet hours .

> **Why staging matters**
> Fewer empty miles · Cars waiting close to expected demand

Good staging keeps cars close to where rides start, so fewer kilometres are driven empty . Poor staging lowers utilisation, the multiplier from chapter 6.

> **Placement cuts deadhead**
> Depot and chargers close to where rides start · Every empty kilometre is on your books

Because the owner pays for every empty kilometre, where your depot and chargers sit matters . A site close to where rides start means shorter empty trips to the first pickup and back for charging and cleaning . When you compare depot options in step 2 of the plan, note the distance to your city's busiest pickup areas . See also the deadhead sections in chapter 6.

> **Parking is not the first bottleneck**
> Normal lots need roughly 300 to 350 sq ft per space · Many malls and industrial lots sit half empty

The author estimates that a normal surface lot needs about 300 to 350 square feet per space, including aisles . Many commercial and industrial lots are empty for much of the day, and their owners are often open to bulk leases . Raw space runs out late . Integration with charging and cleaning becomes the issue first .

Pillar 2 : charging

Short sessions, a human hand

The author works from Tesla's EPA filing : a 48 kWh pack and an unadjusted range of 418 miles, or about 290 to 300 miles in real use .

> **A day of driving**
> About two short fast-charging sessions · A person still plugs the car in

At a demanding day of driving, he estimates two short sessions on a fast charger cover the energy a car needs . Until inductive charging arrives at scale, a person still has to plug the car in . That favours a few concentrated charging sites over many scattered ones .

> **Public chargers first, own stalls later**
> Public stalls can absorb early fleets · Dedicated stalls can work most of the day

Public fast chargers have spare capacity for early fleets . Once a city has many cars, dedicated stalls become necessary, and those can be used far more hours per day than a public stall .

Pillar 3 : cleaning

Night shifts and fleet accounts

A robotaxi carries several riders a day, so it gets dirty faster than a private car . The analysis assumes a proper clean roughly every two days .

> **Partner before you build**
> Commercial washes already run fleet accounts · Night shifts when consumer demand is low

Many commercial car washes already serve taxis, rental cars and delivery vans, and are open to night shifts . For a small fleet, a partner wash with an agreed quality check is the obvious starting point . Building your own facility only makes sense at a much larger scale .

Pillar 4 : maintenance

The lightest pillar

Maintenance is the lightest of the four . The Cybercab is a simple, purpose-built car without a large external sensor suite .

> **What recurs**
> Tyres are the main recurring item · Service centres and mobile tyre vans

The author sees tyres as the only item that recurs often at high mileage . Those can be handled by service centres and mobile tyre vans . Maintenance does not become a structural bottleneck .

What it means for owners

Your garage and your plug

The author's central point : Tesla can build dedicated hubs, but hubs with many stalls and cleaning lines take land, capital and time . Production may soon outgrow them .

> **Why owners may matter**
> Owners bring their own parking and power · Cleaning handled locally

That is why he expects private ownership to become important as production grows . Owners bring parking, power and local cleaning that already exist . Tesla has started its own hubs, such as the Robotaxi hub in Irving near Dallas and a planned charging hub in San Antonio . In his view, those are not yet sized for the full ramp .

> **Your homework**
> Map your staging, plug and wash options · Price each one per car per day in your sheet

For your plan, map the four pillars per car before you buy : where it waits, where it charges and who plugs it in, who cleans it and how often, and who changes the tyres . Put each one in your cost-per-kilometre sheet as its own line .

> *“Raw parking space is not the first bottleneck.”*
> *Paraphrased from @nymbusjp, X article, 30 Jun 2026*

The short version, in the author's words : raw parking space is not the first bottleneck . The real limit is how well staging, charging and cleaning work together .

CHAPTER 6

Cost per Kilometre

The Only Number That Matters

Every fleet plan, sooner or later, comes down to one number . Not the price of the car . Not the size of the fleet . The cost of every kilometre the car drives . This chapter shows you how to build that number, line by line, without guessing what nobody knows yet .

> *“For the consumer it's just going to come down to the cost per mile.”*
> *Tesla engineering team · Munro Live interview, 26 Oct 2026*

Tesla's engineers said it about riders : for the consumer, it is just going to come down to the cost per mile . The same logic works from the owner's side . Riders pay per distance . So your costs have to be understood per distance too .

> *“Utilization ends up mattering more than the purchase price.”*
> *Community member, Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners*

And one of our members added the twist that makes this chapter necessary . Utilisation ends up mattering more than the purchase price . By the end, you will see exactly why .

The worksheet

Two kinds of cost

Let's build the worksheet . It has two kinds of cost .

> **Fixed costs**
> Depreciation · financing · insurance · Depot and parking · admin and software

Fixed costs are the ones you pay whether the car drives or sits still . Depreciation, financing, insurance, the depot and parking, and fixed admin and software .

```
Fixed cost per km = Fixed costs for a period ÷ kilometres driven in that period
```

To turn them into a cost per kilometre, add them up for a period, say a month, and divide by the kilometres the car drove in that month . Keep that division in mind . It is the key to the whole chapter .

> **Variable costs**
> Energy · cleaning · Maintenance, tyres and repairs · downtime

Variable costs grow with every kilometre . Energy, cleaning, maintenance, tyres and repairs . And a downtime allowance, for the days a car is off the road .

```
Cost per km = Fixed cost per km + energy + cleaning + maintenance + downtime
```

Add the two together and you have your cost per kilometre . Now let's look at where each input comes from .

The inputs

One source per cell

Every cell in the worksheet needs a source . A number without a source is just a guess with decimals .

```
Depreciation per km = (Purchase price − residual value) ÷ useful life in km
```

Depreciation is the purchase price minus what the car is worth at the end, divided by its useful life in kilometres . The price is not published yet, so leave it blank or test a range .

Useful life is the big lever . Tesla's engineers say the car is designed to run half a million miles at least . Treat that as a design goal, not a promise . Test a short, a normal and a long life, and watch how much the depreciation line moves .

```
Energy per km = kWh per km × price per kWh ÷ charging efficiency
```

Energy is the kilowatt-hours per kilometre, times your price per kilowatt-hour, divided by your charging efficiency . Use measured values from early fleets once they exist, not brochure numbers .

> **Where the other inputs come from**
> Insurance : broker quote · financing : licensed lender · Depot : lease offer · cleaning and repairs : partner quotes

For the rest : insurance comes from a broker quote . Financing from a licensed lender . The depot from a lease offer and a charger installer . Cleaning and repairs from your own time log or quotes from service partners .

```
Downtime allowance = Days off the road × lost contribution per day
```

Downtime is easy to forget . Days off the road, times what the car would have contributed on those days . Every day in the shop, the fixed costs keep running .

Utilisation

The multiplier

Now the twist . Utilisation .

```
Utilisation = Paid km ÷ total km
```

Utilisation is paid kilometres divided by total kilometres . Every kilometre driven empty, to a pickup or back to the depot, is a kilometre nobody pays for .

```
Total km per day = Active hours × average speed in service
```

And total kilometres per day are your active hours times the average speed in service .

> **Why it beats the price**
> Fixed costs are divided by kilometres · More kilometres : every fixed cost shrinks per km

Now go back to the fixed costs . They are divided by kilometres . Drive twice as many kilometres in a month, and every fixed cost per kilometre halves . That is why a car that drives all day can beat a cheaper car that waits .

Cleaning and charging : the two big running costs

A deep dive from an expert business plan

A rider opens the door and finds crumbs and a coffee cup . They give one star and choose another car next time . A Cybercab has no driver to tidy up between rides, so somebody has to . That is why, in an expert business plan for operating and funding a Cybercab fleet, cleaning comes out as one of the largest running costs of all .

> **What this section covers**
> The two biggest marginal costs · their share of cost per km · What owners can control · what it means for your sheet

This section covers the two biggest running costs after depreciation, how large a share of cost per kilometre they take, and which levers an owner controls .

> **Proof point 1 : cleaning about 20 percent**
> Cleaning ≈ 20% of operating cost per km · No driver to tidy between rides

The business plan estimates cleaning at about 20 percent of total operating cost per kilometre, the largest running cost after depreciation . Frequency, labour cost and whether cleaning happens at your own depot or through a provider decide most of it .

Proof point 2 : charging about 15 percent
Charging ≈ 15% of operating cost per km · Depot charging versus fast charging

Charging comes to about 15 percent in the same plan . Where and when you charge matters : off-peak depot charging is far cheaper than public fast charging, as chapter 5 shows .

The metric to watch
Cleaning + charging ≈ 35% of operating cost per km · Excluding depreciation

Together the two make up about 35 percent of total operating cost per kilometre . Both scale with every kilometre and every ride, so they are the lines where good operations pay off directly .

Wider than one car
Shared depots, cleaning crews and grid contracts · Scale lowers both lines

Both costs fall with scale : one depot with its own crew and grid connection serves many cars . This is a strong argument for owners to cooperate on depots and cleaning, as chapter 11 describes .

What it means for your sheet
Give cleaning and charging their own lines · Get local quotes for both

For step 3 of the plan : never set cleaning to zero, even for a home-owned car, and model charging at the price you will really pay . Ask for local quotes for both before you order .

Depreciation depends on how you fund the car

The second deep dive from the business plan

Two owners run the same car on the same streets . One bought it with cash, one leased it, one shares it through a pooled fleet . Their cleaning and charging bills look alike . Their biggest cost line does not .

What this section covers
Why depreciation is the largest line · How funding changes it · what to ask a lender

This section covers why depreciation is the biggest cost, why its size depends on the funding structure, and what that means for your plan .

Proof point 1 : the largest cost line
Depreciation comes before cleaning and charging

The expert business plan puts depreciation ahead of every running cost . How much of the car's value you write off per kilometre drives the whole cost per kilometre .

Proof point 2 : funding sets the number
Cash purchase · loan · lease · pooled fleet · Each spreads the cost of the car differently

How depreciation lands depends on the funding structure . With a loan you carry the car's value loss plus interest ; with a lease or a pooled fleet, part of the residual-value risk sits with someone else, at a price .

> **Proof point 3 : life in kilometres**
> Battery and vehicle life set the write-off period

Depreciation per kilometre also depends on how many kilometres the car lasts . A longer battery life spreads the same price over more kilometres .

> **The solution in the funding plan**
> Write off over the real life · fund the self-driving part separately · Fund on cash flows , not residual value · lower the purchase cost

Michiel van Duijn presented the expert team's answer in Robotaxi Countdown episode 39 (youtube.com/watch?v=2GpLG7RqqTk) . First, do not write the car or its software down to zero over a four- or five-year lease : the cars can run eight to ten years, so spread the cost over that life . Second, fund the self-driving part separately, with investors who share its upside at a lower cost . Third, for robotaxis, fund on the car's future cash flows rather than its residual value : asset-based interest plus a share of ride income, so the car repays its own loan . Fourth, keep the purchase cost low, because a used car is never worth more than a new one . The separate Funding and Depreciation guide covers this in full .

> **What it means for your plan**
> Decide the funding route before you fix your cost per km · Not financial advice

For step 4 : choose the funding route early, because it changes your largest cost line . Ask each lender or lessor how they treat residual value . This section describes structures, not investments . Not financial advice .

One analyst's cost per mile , line by line

Ten cost drivers for a ride-hailing car

Before Tesla publishes anything , one of the most detailed public breakdowns of a robotaxi's cost per mile comes from analyst AJ (@alojoh) , built from company filings . It confirms the deep dives above : depreciation first , then cleaning and electricity .

Cost driver	Key inputs	¢ per mile	¢ per km	Share
Depreciation	Vehicle $21K · 4-year life · 313K mi total	7.2	4.5	45.5 %
Cleaning	Every 345 mi · $11.4 per clean	3.3	2.1	20.7 %
Electricity	18 kWh per 100 mi · 13.2 ¢ per kWh	2.4	1.5	15.0 %
Interior refurbishment	$815 per 80K mi	1.0	0.6	6.4 %
Tires and wheels	$255 per 30K mi	0.8	0.5	5.3 %
Insurance equivalent	$204 a year per 15K mi , 50% discount	0.6	0.4	3.6 %
Wipers	$15 per 10K mi	0.2	0.1	1.0 %
Brakes	$102 per 80K mi (regenerative braking)	0.1	0.1	0.8 %
Air filter and AC	$36 per 40K mi	0.1	0.1	0.5 %
All other	$51 per 30K mi	0.2	0.1	1.1 %
Total	**Forecast for Q1 2027**	**15.9**	**9.9**	**100 %**

Notes from the source : cost per mile is per mile driven , meaning total miles including empty miles , not paid miles · the forecast includes 2.5 % yearly inflation · vehicle cost , cleaning and electricity together make up more than 80 % of the cost per mile . Kilometre values converted by us (÷ 1.609) . Source : AJ (@alojoh) , Tesla Ride Hailing Cost Drivers , Part 1 , Cost per Mile Driven , based on company filings , 8 May 2025 . Figures are his estimates for a Tesla-operated fleet , in US dollars .

> **What it means for your sheet**
> Use these ten lines as a checklist · Replace each input with a local quote

Use the ten lines as a checklist for your own cost sheet , and swap each input for a local figure . Note that his figures assume a Tesla-operated fleet in the US .

> **The utilisation trade-off**
> Busier cars mean longer waits at peak times · Quiet hours may allow other work, such as deliveries

Analyst @cernbasher adds a nuance . A network where every car is always busy has long wait times at peak hours . Some spare capacity keeps waits short and riders happy . Plan your careful case with lower utilisation, and note any off-peak work Tesla's terms may allow .

> **Who pays for empty kilometres ?**
> Rideshare : the driver mostly absorbs the empty stretch · Robotaxi : the owner pays for every empty kilometre

A post by @m0xt_ makes the point sharply . In today's rideshare, the driver mostly carries the cost of driving empty : their time, their energy, the wear on their car . With a robotaxi, the owner carries it . Every empty kilometre still costs depreciation, insurance, energy, cleaning and remote oversight .

> **Deadhead as a share of all kilometres**
> An analyst estimate cited by @m0xt_ : about 35% of robotaxi miles unpaid · A crude estimate from 2024 , not a fact

He cites an analyst estimate from September 2024 that about 35 percent of robotaxi miles carry no rider . The analyst called it crude . Use it only as a careful-case starting point, and replace it with

measured values from early fleets as soon as they exist .

> **Removing the driver is not removing the fleet**
> Insurance · remote oversight · charging · cleaning · Maintenance · parking · software and connectivity

Taking out the driver removes one cost line, not the fleet . Insurance, remote oversight, charging, cleaning, maintenance, parking and connectivity all stay . Give each one its own line in your sheet . And watch the empty-kilometre share of early fleets : it may be one of the clearest signals of whether a fleet works .

So where your car runs, and how many rides it gets, can shape your result more than what you paid for it . That is the reason chapter two asked you to pick your city so carefully .

The network side

What you cannot set

Then there is the side of the sheet you cannot fill in yourself .

> **Set by the network operator**
> Ride price · your share of each fare · How many rides reach your car

The ride price, the owner's share of each fare, and how many rides the network sends to your car are all set by the network operator . None of them have been published . They stay as inputs, never as facts .

Three cases

Low · base · high

So you run three cases .

> **Run three cases**
> Careful · middle · hopeful value per unknown · Change one input at a time

For each unknown, pick a careful, a middle and a hopeful value . Then change one input at a time, and see which ones move your cost per kilometre most .

> **Stress test**
> Lower utilisation · shorter life · Costlier insurance or energy · start date slips

Then stress-test the plan . Lower utilisation, for example if your city caps owner cars . A shorter life, or a new hardware version that cuts resale value . More expensive insurance or energy . And a start date that slips while rent and interest keep running .

If your plan only works in the hopeful case, it is not a plan yet . If it still holds in the careful case, you are ready for the day the real terms come out . You swap the ranges for real values, and you have your answer in minutes .

CHAPTER 7

Funding Your Fleet

Ask future fleet owners what keeps them up at night, and the answer is rarely the car . It is the money . How do you pay for the first car, and the next ones ? This chapter walks through the routes, what a lender wants to see, and why funding only ever goes through licensed partners .

> *“I don't have the capital.”*
> *Community member, Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners*

It is the most common message in our community . I don't have the capital . That is a fair starting point, and it is where most real fleets begin .

The routes

Six ways to pay

There is no single right way to fund a fleet . There are six routes, and most owners end up mixing them .

> **Route one : own cash**
> Full control · no lender · Your own money carries all the risk

Route one is your own cash . You keep full control and nobody else has a say . The catch is simple : if the plan goes wrong, every loss is yours, and cash in a car is cash you cannot use for anything else .

> **Route two : a bank or business loan**
> You own the car · the bank has a claim · Needs a plan the bank can check

Route two is a bank or business loan . You own the car, but the bank has a claim on it and on your repayments . A bank lends against a plan it can check, so the quality of your paperwork matters as much as the car .

> **Route three : lease or asset finance**
> A lessor owns or finances the car · Ask how the contract treats high mileage

Route three is a lease or asset finance . A lessor owns or finances the car and you pay for its use . Read the contract closely . A robotaxi drives far more than a normal car, so ask how the terms treat high mileage and wear .

Route four : co-ownership
Several people own a fleet together · Usually through a company

Route four is co-ownership . Several people or partners own the fleet together, usually through a company with shareholders . It spreads the cost and the risk, but it also spreads the decisions, so agree the rules before the first car arrives .

Route five : reinvesting
Grow the fleet step by step · Slower, but no new lender

Route five is reinvesting . You start small and add cars one step at a time, from the fleet itself . It is slower, but you do not add new lenders as you grow .

Route six : tax and subsidy checks
Ask an adviser what applies to you · Rules differ by country and change often

Route six is not a source of money on its own . It is checking what tax rules and subsidies apply to an electric business vehicle where you live . They differ by country and change often, so ask an adviser instead of assuming .

Each route trades control, speed and risk in a different way . None of them is the best for everyone . The right mix depends on your city, your appetite for risk, and how fast you want to grow .

The lender pack

What lenders want to see

Whichever route you pick, anyone who funds you will ask the same questions . So prepare the answers before you ask .

Your lender pack
Business plan · cash-flow forecast with visible assumptions · Insurance quote · depot and charging plan

A good lender pack starts with a short business plan and a cash-flow forecast . Show every assumption, especially your cost per kilometre worksheet from chapter six . Add an insurance quote or a broker letter, and your depot and charging plan .

And the rest of the pack
Permit status in your city · company details · Your own contribution · a risk register

Then the rest . What is the legal status of driverless rides in your city today ? Which company will own the cars ? How much of your own money goes in ? And a risk register that names what could go wrong and what you would do about it .

The boring parts

Cleaning · charging · breakdowns

A lender also likes to see that you have thought about the boring parts . Who cleans the car ? Where does it charge ? What happens on the day it breaks down ? Those answers make a plan believable .

The open questions

What lenders will probe

A careful lender will also push on what nobody knows yet . Be ready for it .

> **Unknowns to name, not hide**
> No published price · no published owner terms · High-mileage lease terms · start dates can slip

Tesla has not published a price for owners, and it has not published owner terms . Lease terms for very high mileage are still new . And start dates can slip . Name these unknowns in your plan . A lender trusts a plan that admits them far more than one that hides them .

That is also why your forecast should show three cases, careful, middle and hopeful, and why you should never borrow on the hopeful one .

Licensed partners only

Raising money is regulated

Now the part that matters most . The moment you raise money from other people, you are in regulated territory .

> **Public offers to investors**
> Platforms that publicly offer loans or shares may need a licence · Marketing must be correct, clear and not misleading

In many countries, and across the EU under the European crowdfunding rules, a platform that publicly offers business loans or shares to investors needs a licence from the financial regulator . Its marketing must be correct, clear and not misleading . Check the rules in your country before you raise money from the public .

> **What that means for you**
> Co-ownership can count as an offering · Get legal advice before you invite investors

For you, that means a co-ownership plan can count as an investment offering, even among a small group . Get legal advice before you invite anyone to put money in . Other countries have their own regulator and their own rules .

What our community does and does not do
We share knowledge and checklists · We do not arrange, advise on or offer funding

And to be clear about us . Our community shares knowledge, checklists and experience . We do not arrange funding, advise on funding, or offer investments . Funding only ever goes through licensed partners .

Start small

Phase your purchases

One last habit that every lender likes . Phase your purchases .

Phase it
One car first · learn the real numbers · Then grow with evidence, not hope

Start with one car, or a few . Track what it really costs and how much it really drives . Then take those real numbers to your lender for the next step . Growing on evidence is cheaper and safer than growing on hope .

Three ways to take part

Owner, passive owner or pooled fleet

Two neighbours both want a Cybercab . One wants to run it himself : find the depot, arrange the cleaning, watch the car every day . The other wants to own it but never touch it . A third person in the street would rather put money into a shared fleet . All three are future fleet owners . Which route you pick changes almost every step of your plan .

What this section covers
Three possible routes · what each asks of you · What to watch · what it means for your funding plan

This section covers three possible routes to taking part, what each asks of you, the one thing to watch, and what that means for step 4 of the plan .

Route 1 : own and run it yourself
Most involvement : depot, cleaning, uptime · Most exposed to utilisation, resale value and network rule changes

Analyst @cernbasher compares the routes to the layers of a capital stack . In the first, you buy the car and run the physical side yourself inside Tesla's network . You carry the most work, and you are most exposed to how busy the car is, what it is worth later, and changes to the network's rules .

Route 2 : own it , Tesla operates it
Possible structured programmes from Tesla · Less work, less flexibility , depends on Tesla's terms

In the second route, which he sees as possible but which Tesla has not announced, you own the car and Tesla runs it, for example through a structured programme . You do less work, but you also have less control and depend fully on Tesla's terms .

> **Route 3 : a pooled fleet**
> Many investors share a fleet run by a manager · Spread over cities , minimal involvement , manager and liquidity risk

In the third, a pooled fleet or fund buys many cars and a manager runs them . You are hardly involved and the risk is spread over cities and cars . But you depend on the manager, pay for that management, and may not be able to exit quickly .

> **The thing to watch**
> Tesla's owner terms decide which routes exist · Your cost per kilometre still applies on every route

The one thing to watch is Tesla's owner terms : they decide which of these routes will exist at all . On every route, the cost per kilometre from chapter 6 stays the test of whether a car works .

> **Wider than cars**
> Aircraft leasing · energy storage · data-centre capacity

He compares robotaxis to other assets where a central operator runs capacity that others own, such as aircraft leasing, energy storage and data-centre capacity . It is a useful way to explain your plan to a lender or partner .

> **What it means for your plan**
> Decide which route fits your time and skills · Not financial advice

For step 4 of the plan : decide early which route fits your time, skills and appetite for risk, because it changes what a lender wants to see . This section describes structures, not investments . Not financial advice .

Growing a fleet from one car

The compounding idea and its limits

Picture someone with modest savings and one car . Every month the car's spare cash goes into a pot, and each time the pot covers a down payment, another car is ordered . A year later there are a handful of cars . That is the picture analyst @cernbasher sketches, and it explains why so many future owners think in fleets, not single cars .

> **What this section covers**
> How reinvesting works · what speeds it up · What slows it down · what it means for your funding plan

This section covers the reinvestment idea, the inputs that drive its speed, the real-world limits, and what that means for step 4 of the plan .

> **Proof point 1 : slow, then fast**
> Few cars in year one · Growth accelerates once several cars contribute

In his scenario the fleet grows slowly at first, then faster, because every new car adds to the pot . He uses his individual-owner cost model with all expenses, a fixed down payment per car and a bank loan for the rest .

> **Proof point 2 : sensitive to every input**
> Utilisation · fares · financing terms · A small change compounds over years

He shows that changing one input, such as the fare level, changes the outcome dramatically, because the effect compounds . The same is true in the other direction : a lower utilisation or higher costs slow growth just as strongly .

> **Proof point 3 : real-world constraints**
> Car supply from Tesla · parking and depot space · Lender appetite · local permits

He warns against taking the projection to the bank . It assumes Tesla can and will sell you as many cars as you want, and ignores where the cars park, how lenders react and what local rules allow .

> **The metric to watch**
> Cost per kilometre per car, at fleet scale · See chapter 6

Growth only works if each car covers its own cost per kilometre . As a fleet grows, depot, cleaning and staff costs appear that a single home-owned car does not have . Keep the cost sheet per car .

> **What it means for your plan**
> Plan growth in stages, each backed by real numbers · Not financial advice

For step 4 : treat reinvestment as a staged plan, where each next car is funded only after the previous ones show real cost and use data . Lenders will ask for that evidence anyway . This section describes a structure, not an investment . Not financial advice .

CHAPTER 8

Rules of the Road

US vs Europe

A Cybercab is only useful where the law lets it drive with nobody behind the wheel . Those laws look very different in the United States and in Europe . This chapter walks through both, layer by layer, so you know who decides what in your city .

Why rules come first

The real bottleneck

The technology already works in a growing number of cities . According to Social Capital's deep dive, regulation, not technology, is now the real bottleneck . That is why this step matters so much .

> **Levels of autonomy**
> Level 2 : the driver supervises · Level 4 : driverless within a defined area · Level 5 : driverless everywhere, in all conditions

The industry uses six levels, from zero to five, defined by the engineering body SAE . At level 2, as with FSD Supervised, a human must watch the road . At level 4, the car drives itself without a human, but only inside a defined area and conditions . That is where robotaxis run today . Level 5 means driving anywhere, in any conditions, and nobody offers that yet . The level decides which rules apply to your car .

> **The Arizona model**
> An early, light-touch state framework · Driverless service started there first

Arizona is the example the deep dive points to . The state chose a light-touch framework early, and Waymo launched its first driverless service there . The lesson for owners : the place with clear, early rules is often where driverless service starts . Rank the cities on your shortlist by how clear their rules are, not only by demand .

The United States

Two layers

In the United States there are two layers . The federal government sets the rules for the car . Each state sets the rules for running it on its roads .

The federal layer
NHTSA sets the vehicle safety standards · Makers certify their own cars against them

The federal layer is the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration . It writes the vehicle safety standards . Car makers certify their own cars against those standards, and the agency checks that certification .

The Cybercab case
Paid service began in Austin, 3 September 2026 · NHTSA opened an audit of the self-certification

That check is happening right now . Tesla began paid Cybercab service in Austin on the third of September . A day later the agency announced an audit of how Tesla certified a car with no steering wheel and no pedals .

Where it stands today
Tesla's sworn answers are due 30 October 2026 · No violation found · existing standards still apply

Tesla's sworn answers are due today, the thirtieth of October . The agency has not found a violation . It is rewriting several standards written for human drivers, but until that work is done, the existing standards stay in force .

For a future owner, the lesson is simple . The car itself sits under a federal review that is still open . Follow it, but do not try to predict it .

Texas

An authorization to operate

Now the state layer . Texas is where Tesla runs Cybercabs today, so it is the clearest example .

Texas Senate Bill 2807
Since 28 May 2026 : commercial driverless operation · needs an active authorization from TxDMV

Under Senate Bill 2807, since the twenty-eighth of May 2026, any company running driverless vehicles commercially in Texas needs an active authorization from the Texas Department of Motor Vehicles .

What the operator confirms
The car follows traffic law · has a recording device · Can stop safely on a failure · is registered and insured

To get it, the operator confirms that each car can follow traffic law, carries a recording device, can reach a safe stop if the system fails, and is registered and insured . It also hands the state police a plan for how first responders deal with the car .

Who enforces
TxDMV issues and can revoke the authorization · State and local police enforce on the road

The motor vehicle department issues the authorization and can restrict or revoke it . The state police and local police enforce the rules on the road . A car used only for personal driving needs no authorization .

California

Two agencies

California works differently . There, two agencies are involved .

DMV, then CPUC
DMV : testing with a driver, then driverless, then deployment · CPUC : passenger permits and a passenger safety plan

The Department of Motor Vehicles controls the car on the road, from testing with a safety driver, to driverless testing, to a deployment permit . The Public Utilities Commission controls carrying passengers . It requires a charter permit and a passenger safety plan, and fares are only allowed in its deployment programme .

The owner question
In Texas and California the operator holds the permits · Tesla has not said who holds them for owner cars

Here is the question for owners . In both states, the permits sit with the operator . Tesla has not said whether owner cars would run under its permits or need their own . Until it does, that is an open question in every plan .

Europe and the EU

A different starting point

Now Europe . The starting point is very different .

Supervised is not driverless
National approvals of FSD Supervised · A driver stays responsible

In 2026 national vehicle authorities in Europe began approving Tesla's supervised driving system . That is driver assistance . A person stays behind the wheel and stays responsible . It is not a robotaxi .

The EU vote
EU-wide recognition needs a vote of member states · No vote has passed yet

For that approval to count across the whole EU, member states must vote on it in a technical committee . That vote has not passed yet .

> **The EU driverless route**
> Type approval for automated driving systems, small series · A route for makers · not a taxi permit

Brussels also has a route for truly driverless vehicles : an EU type approval for automated driving systems built in small series . It exists, but it is a route for makers, and it does not by itself permit a taxi service .

> **Driverless in Europe today**
> Mostly through national experiment or pilot permits · Limited roads, times and conditions

Driverless cars in most European countries can run today only through national experiment or pilot permits, which set the roads, times, weather and safety rules .

> **Taxi law**
> National taxi rules assume a human driver · Licences · driver cards · on-board equipment

And then taxi law . Most national taxi rules are written around a human driver, with licences, driver cards and on-board equipment . How that applies to a car with no driver is not settled .

Side by side

What it means for you

So let's put the two side by side .

> **Side by side**
> US : paid driverless rides run today, under operator permits · Europe : mostly experiments · no general commercial route yet

In the United States, paid driverless rides already run, under permits held by the operator, while the car's federal certification is under review . In Europe, driverless cars mostly run in experiments, and there is no general commercial route yet .

> **What to do now**
> Talk to your municipality · follow the EU vote · Plan for a later start in Europe

So what can you do now ? Talk to your municipality . Follow the EU vote . Ask Tesla, when it publishes owner terms, who holds the permits . And if you live in Europe, plan for a later start than in Texas .

CHAPTER 9

Start Small, Scale Smart

Plenty of future owners dream of twenty cars on day one . The owners who last will probably start with far fewer . This chapter is about growing in steps : how to phase your fleet, which risks come with each step, and how to plan your way out before you plan your way in .

Phasing

Grow in batches

The core idea is simple . Do not buy your whole fleet at once . Buy in batches, and let each batch teach you something before you buy the next .

> **Starter : one to four cars**
> Learn the business · home or rented parking with fast charging · Main risk : one car's downtime hits hard

The starter phase is one to four cars . The goal is to learn the business . You need parking with fast charging and a cleaning routine you can handle . The main risk : when one car is off the road, a big share of your fleet is off the road .

> **Small fleet : five to ten**
> A small depot or reserved bays · your own chargers · Main risk : fixed depot costs before the fleet is fully used

The small fleet is five to ten cars . Now you need a small depot or reserved bays, your own chargers or a charging contract, a company and proper bookkeeping . The main risk is paying fixed depot costs before the fleet is busy enough to carry them .

> **Operator : ten to twenty**
> A dedicated depot with a grid connection · staff or a service partner · Main risk : grid lead times and lender conditions

At ten to twenty cars you are an operator . That means a dedicated depot with a grid connection sized for charging many cars at once, staff or a service partner, fleet insurance and lender-grade reporting . The main risks are long waits for a grid connection and the conditions lenders attach .

> **Scale : twenty and up**
> Several sites or one large hub · round-the-clock cover · Main risk : everything depends on one city's terms

Beyond twenty cars you are a regional operator, with several sites or one large hub and round-the-clock cover . The main risk is concentration . If the terms or permits in your city change, your whole fleet feels it .

> *“This car is going to be progressively improved at a rapid rate.”*
> *Tesla engineering team · Munro Live interview, 26 Oct 2026*

There is one more reason to phase . Tesla's engineers said this car is going to be progressively improved at a rapid rate . So buying your whole fleet from the very first production version may not be the smartest move .

The rule of thumb : track the real cost per kilometre and the real utilisation of every car for a few months . Then decide the next batch on that evidence .

Timing

First mover or fast follower

Then there is the question of timing . Should you be first in line, or wait and follow ?

> **First mover**
> Early cars · early learning · a place in the queue · But : unknown terms and a first production version

Being first can mean an early place in the queue and a head start on learning . But you buy before the owner terms are known, and possibly from the first production version .

> **Fast follower**
> Learn from others · clearer terms · an improved car · But : a busier city and a later start

Following fast means you learn from early owners, the terms are clearer, and the car has improved . But your city may be busier by then, and you start later . Neither is right for everyone . Decide which risk you would rather carry .

The risk register

Write it down

Whatever you choose, keep a risk register . It is a simple list, and lenders love it .

> **For each risk, write down**
> What could happen · how likely · how bad · Your early warning sign · what you will do

For each risk, write down what could happen, how likely it is, and how bad it would be . Then add an early warning sign, and what you will do when you see it .

Risks most owners should list
Start date slips · terms differ from your plan · A long repair · depot or grid delays · rule changes

Most owners should list at least these . The start date slips . The owner terms differ from your plan . A car needs a long repair . The depot or the grid connection is late . Or the rules in your city change .

Review it monthly

Fewer surprises

Review the register every month . A risk you look at often is a risk that rarely surprises you .

Exit options

Plan the way out

Now the part almost nobody plans . How do you get out ?

Ways out
Sell cars one by one · sell the company · Hand operations to a partner · stop at a phase

There are several ways out . Sell the cars one by one . Sell the company that owns them . Hand the daily operations to a partner . Or simply stop growing at a phase that works for you .

Build the exit in now
Co-owners : agree exit terms in the shareholder agreement · Depot and lease contracts : check the notice terms

Build those exits in from the start . If you co-own, agree the exit terms in the shareholder agreement before the first car arrives . And check how much notice your depot and lease contracts need if you want to stop .

Reinvestment rules

Decide before the money comes in

The last habit is about growth . Write your reinvestment rules before any money comes in, not after .

Example rules to write down
Only grow on real numbers, never on forecasts · Keep a buffer first · one batch at a time

Your rules might say : only grow on real numbers, never on forecasts . Keep a buffer for repairs and slow months before you buy more . And add one batch at a time . The exact rules are yours to set, with your adviser .

Start small, learn fast, and scale on evidence . That is how a fleet survives its first year .

CHAPTER 10

Your 90-Day Readiness Plan

Tesla has not published owner terms . That does not mean you have to wait . Almost everything that makes a fleet ready is in your own hands . This last chapter turns the whole book into a ninety-day plan, with a clear test for when each step is done .

How to use this plan
Three blocks of thirty days · Each step has a done-when test

We split the plan into three blocks of thirty days . The split is ours, not Tesla's . What matters is the done-when test for each step . If you can't say it's done, it's not done .

Days 1 to 30

Where and who

The first thirty days are about where you will operate and who you are .

Step one : shortlist one to three cities
Done when you know each city's legal status · Tesla status · and signs of demand

Step one . Shortlist one to three cities . It is done when you know each city's legal status, whether Tesla is live there, has announced it, or neither, and what the demand looks like .

Step two : register interest with Tesla
The interest form at tesla.com/robotaxi · It is not an order

Step two . Register your interest with Tesla through the interest form on its robotaxi page . It is done when the form is submitted . Remember, it is not an order .

Step three : choose an entity
Done when the company structure is agreed · with your accountant or lawyer

Step three . Set up or choose an entity . It is done when you have agreed the company structure with your accountant or lawyer .

Step four : join the community and pin your city
Member of the X community · City added to the fleet map

Step four . Join the community and pin your city . It is done when you are a member of the community on X and your city is on the fleet map .

Days 31 to 60

Where the cars live

The second block is about the physical side : where the cars live, and who looks after them .

> **Step five : starting size and phasing**
> Done when batch one's size is written down · and the trigger for batch two

Step five . Choose your starting size and phasing . It is done when the size of your first batch, and the trigger for your second, are written down .

> **Step six : secure depot options**
> At least one site with confirmed grid capacity · and a charger plan

Step six . Secure depot options . It is done when you have at least one site with confirmed grid capacity and a plan for the chargers .

> **Step seven : decide who does the operations**
> Yourself, or a named partner · for operations only or full operations

Step seven . Decide who does the operations . Yourself, or a partner for operations only, or for everything . It is done when you have made the choice, and if it is a partner, you can name them .

> **Step eight : collect insurance quotes**
> Done when you have indicative quotes · or broker letters from two or three brokers

Step eight . Collect insurance quotes . It is done when you have indicative quotes or broker letters from two or three brokers .

By day sixty, your plan has a city, a company, a place to park and charge, and an idea of who keeps the cars clean and running .

Days 61 to 90

The numbers and the money

The last block puts it all on paper .

> **Step nine : build your cost-per-km model**
> Low, base and high cases filled in · The plan survives the low case

Step nine . Build your cost per kilometre model from chapter six . It is done when the low, base and high cases are filled in, and your plan still survives the low case .

If it only works in the hopeful case, it is not ready yet . Change the plan, not the numbers .

> **Step ten : prepare the lender pack**
> Done when the pack has gone to at least one · licensed funding partner

Step ten . Prepare the lender pack from chapter seven . It is done when the pack has gone to at least one licensed funding partner .

> **Step eleven : track the open questions**
> Owner terms · caps per city · city launches · EU and national votes

Step eleven . Track the open questions . It is done when you have a watch list : the owner terms, caps per city, new city launches, and the votes in the EU and in national parliaments .

Owner pilots

What early deliveries may test

Analysts such as @nymbusjp expect Tesla to run pilot deliveries to private owners before owner sales scale up . If that happens, the pilots are likely to test the pieces that are still open .

> **Likely pilot topics**
> Insurance for private robotaxi owners · financing · Owner support for cleaning and maintenance · revenue share and app integration

Those pieces are insurance products for private owners, financing, support for cleaning and maintenance, and how revenue sharing and the app work . Add each one to your list of open questions in step eleven, and watch for the first private deliveries . They are the signal that the window is opening for owners .

Day 90

Ready to move

At day ninety you are not guaranteed a car or a place on the network . Nobody is yet . But you are ready to move the day the terms come out, while others are only starting to read .

FAQ : qualifying as a fleet operator

The questions owners ask most

Two questions come up under almost every post about fleets : how do I qualify as a fleet operator, and when can private owners add their own cars ? Here is what is known today .

> **How do I qualify as a fleet operator ?**
> Tesla has not published criteria yet · Expect : business entity · insurance · depot · local permits

Tesla has not published criteria for fleet operators . Based on how ride-hailing and taxi rules work today, expect to need a registered business, commercial insurance, a place to charge, clean and park the cars, and the permits your city requires . The ninety-day plan in this guide prepares exactly those parts, so you are ready when the criteria come out .

> **When can private owners add cars ?**
> Tesla says : around Q2 2027 for customer cars · First in cities where the Robotaxi network already runs

Tesla has said customer cars can join the Robotaxi fleet around the second quarter of 2027, as noted from @fminderop on X . Expect it to start in cities where the network already runs, such as Austin, with Dallas a likely next step . Until then, nobody can add a private car, so use the time to prepare .

> **What should I do now ?**
> Pick your city · secure a depot option · get an insurance letter · Share your plan in the community

Share your city, the number of cars you want to start with, and when, in the community . Every plan helps other owners learn, and it helps us track where demand is building .

JOIN US

Build your fleet plan with the community

This guide was written by the expert team of the Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners community . Discuss every chapter with other future owners :

X community
https://x.com/i/communities/1912893645050511710

Website , fleet map and free readiness guide
cybercabfleetowners.com

Not financial advice . Tesla has not published owner terms ; all plans are subject to Tesla's and local regulators' rules . This guide contains no earnings , return or fee figures . Chapter 11 and the pilot section in chapter 10 paraphrase the X article “Tesla’s Secret Weapon for Scaling Robotaxis Isn’t What You Think” by @nymbusjp (30 Jun 2026 , x.com/nymbusjp/status/2072051589578166716) . Chapter 12 and the utilisation section in chapter 6 paraphrase posts by @cernbasher collected in his X article “The Cybercab Era Begins” (29 Aug 2026 , x.com/cernbasher/status/2093662096865038490) . The airline-model section in chapter 12 paraphrases a post by @farzyness (3 Sep 2026 , x.com/farzyness/status/2095591558217093273) . The deadhead sections in chapters 6 and 11 paraphrase a post by @m0xt_ (15 Sep 2026 , x.com/m0xt_/status/2099838186440753418) , which cites an analyst estimate from 2024 . The proof points in the introduction , and the sections on Tesla versus Waymo , rules as the bottleneck , the Arizona model and China , draw on the public summary of Social Capital's deep dive by @chamath , “What Happens When Cars Drive Themselves” (31 Jul 2026 , chamath.substack.com/p/autonomous-driving) , which cites Waymo's peer-reviewed safety data , Goldman Sachs and Aurora . The levels of autonomy follow the SAE J3016 standard . The section How a city tips in chapter 2 paraphrases a second X article by @cernbasher , “The Economics of Disruption : Tesla vs Uber in Austin , Tx” (10 Apr 2026 , x.com/CernBasher/status/2042585299096621190) . The section Three ways to take part in chapter 7 paraphrases a third X article by @cernbasher , “Robotaxi as a New Asset Class” (15 Mar 2026 , x.com/CernBasher/status/2033174199309680802) . The two deep dives on cleaning , charging and depreciation in chapter 6 draw on an expert business plan for operating and funding a Cybercab fleet , written by members of the expert team . The funding plan solution in chapter 6 paraphrases Michiel van Duijn in Robotaxi Countdown episode 39 (youtube.com/watch?v=2GpLG7RqqTk) . The cost driver table in chapter 6 rebuilds a slide by AJ (@alojoh) , Tesla Ride Hailing Cost Drivers (8 May 2025) , based on company filings . The section Growing a fleet from one car in chapter 7 paraphrases a fourth X article by @cernbasher , “Building Your Cybercab Fleet” (9 Mar 2026 , x.com/CernBasher/status/2030979224819900515) . The timeline and Texas fleet status in chapter 1 and the FAQ in chapter 10 draw on posts from @fminderop on X (23 and 31 Oct 2026) ; the depot , zoning and insurance notes summarise questions from community members . Return , revenue , price and fee figures from all sources are left out . Quotes from Tesla engineers are from the Munro Live interview of 26 Oct 2026 , paraphrased where needed . Independent community, not affiliated with Tesla, Inc.